

form that has been sent in an e-mail unless you are absolutely sure of its authenticity.

3. Sending personal financial information over e-mail is very risky, especially if it has been “requested”. If you are submitting financial information on a Web site, look for the “lock” icon in your browser’s status bar, which denotes that the source is secure. Some phishers go so far as to create secure Web forms for submitting data, but that’s relatively unlikely.

4. View the SSL certificate of the site in question. You can do this by double-clicking on the lock icon.

5. Use a little common sense and judgment when taking a call on e-mails. More often than not, you can tell that an e-mail is suspicious, just by the way in which it is written. A Nigerian prince—especially one who doesn’t know you—isn’t likely to shower you with money. Don’t ask us how some people actually fell for the scam!

6.3.1 Fighting It

Apart from standard spam filters, there are several downloadable tools that can help you block phishing attempts. Phishing generally falls under the purview of spam, so if you are searching for a phishing-only software, you’ll probably get a range of anti-spam software that also block phishing.

However, phishing-only tools do exist. One such is the Cloudmark Anti-Fraud Toolbar. The toolbar, meant only for Internet Explorer, blocks you from visiting both phishing sites and sites whose content is not 100 per cent verifiable. The toolbar sits in your browser under the address bar and monitors the contents of the pages you are visiting. It gives you a rating of the site—safe, questionable or unsafe. If the site visited falls in the “unsafe” rating, it is blocked immediately. However, if this is some content that you wish to see, you can unblock the site for viewing.